TEMPLATE P24 · OPERATIONS MANUAL

# Operations manual

Brings together what is needed to operate the AI system in production in a stable and controlled manner: owners, routines, changes, common situations, continuity and records.

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01

# Instructions for use

| Aspect | Guidance |
|---|---|
| **When it is used** | It is drafted in phase 5 (a requirement of P23) and approved at the start of phase 6. It is kept alive throughout operation. |
| **Who completes it** | AI Operations Owner, with the AI Technical Owner. |
| **Who verifies it** | AI Office at Lite intensity; AI Auditor at Enterprise intensity. |

| Aspect | Guidance |
|---|---|
| **At which *gate* it is reviewed** | Prerequisite for G5; its currency is checked at each R6 continuity review. |
| **Lite versus Enterprise** | Lite may omit the fields marked **(Enterprise)**. |
| **Relationship** | P16 Lineage · P17 Human oversight · P18 Security · P19 Rollback · P25 Monitoring and alerts · P26 Incident response · P27 Incident and change log · P28 Value tracking · document 52 (AI operations manual). |

Rules:

- The manual must be usable by an on-call person who **has not taken part in the build**.
- Detailed technical procedures may reside in the company's operations tool; here they are linked with their version.
- Every change in production is classified and recorded in P27 before it is executed, except emergency changes, which are recorded immediately afterwards.

02

# Identification

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **Use case code** | | IA-AAAA-NNN (T01). |
| **AI system(s)** | | Identifier in the inventory (T02). |
| **Version in production** | | Model, instructions and configuration (P16). |
| **Go-live date** | | As per P23. |
| **Intensity** | | Lite · Enterprise. Determines the frequency of R6: quarterly at Enterprise and half-yearly at Lite. |
| **Autonomy level** | | A0 · A1 · A2 · A3. |
| **Document version** | | |
| **Author** | | Role and name. |

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **Date** | | DD-MM-YYYY. |
| **Document status** | | Draft · Submitted for verification · Verified · Approved · Superseded. |

03

# Operational description

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **What the system does** | | Summary of P31, in plain language. |
| **Users and service hours** | | Who uses it and when it must be available. |
| **Committed service levels** | | Availability, response time, resolution time. |
| **Internal dependencies** | | Systems and data on which it depends. |
| **Suppliers and support (Enterprise)** | | Supplier, service, support channel and contracted service level (P14). |
| **Known limitations** | | From P16 and P21; what the system must not be asked to do. They are carried over to the internal instructions for use (P49 §5). |

04

# Operational roles and contacts

Roles and channels are indicated; personal contact details are kept in the corporate directory.

| Role | Holder | Deputy | Availability | Channel |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **AI Operations Owner** | | | | |
| **Technical on-call** | | | | |
| **AI Technical Owner** | | | | |
| **AI Product Owner** | | | | |

| Role | Holder | Deputy | Availability | Channel |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Designated supervisors (P17)** | | | | |
| **Information security** | | | | |
| **Data protection** | | | | |
| **AI Risk Owner** | | | | |

05

# Operational routines

**Frequency:** Continuous · Daily · Weekly · Monthly · Quarterly · Half-yearly.

| Activity | Frequency | Owner | Procedure or link | Record |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Review open alerts and their handling** | Daily | Technical on-call | P25 | Alerting tool |
| **Check the quality and freshness of input data** | Daily | | | |
| **Review a sample of outputs (after-the-fact oversight)** | As per P17 | Designated supervisors | P17 block 6 | |
| **Review the agent action log and blocks** | Weekly | | P18 block 10 | |
| **Review consumption and cost against budget** | Monthly | | P25 | |
| **Review drift (including usage drift), bias and performance against the reference** | Monthly | | P25 | |
| **Review system permissions and identities** | Quarterly | | P18 blocks 4 and 5 | |
| **Update value tracking** | As per P28 | AI Product Owner | P28 | |
| **Prepare the R6 continuity review** | Quarterly (Enterprise) · Half-yearly (Lite) | AI Operations Owner | Block 10 | P29 |

06

# Change management

| Type of change | Examples | Required testing | Who approves | Does it require reviewing classification, intensity or risks? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Minor** | Adjustment of interface texts; alert threshold with no effect on behaviour | Functional verification | AI Operations Owner | No |
| **Relevant** | New version of the model, instructions or knowledge base; new tools or permissions for the agent; change in autonomy level; extension of population or purpose; change of supplier | Regression, bias, security and injection testing as applicable; rollback prepared | As per document 52; if autonomy, purpose or classification changes, a decision equivalent to G4/G5 and a new sign-off (P23) | Yes |
| **Emergency** | Containment of an incident | Whatever is possible without delaying containment | Incident coordinator, with immediate recording | Reviewed afterwards |

07

# Common situations

| Situation | Symptom or alert | First action | Escalate to | Reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Performance degradation** | Performance alert or increase in overrides | Check input data and version; assess rollback trigger | AI Technical Owner | P19 · P25 |
| **Missing or late input data** | Freshness alert | Activate degraded mode if thresholds are exceeded | Data owner | P19 |
| **Model provider unavailable** | Service errors | Apply the planned alternative; inform users | AI Operations Owner | P14 · P19 |
| **Consumption cost above threshold** | Cost alert | Review anomalous usage; apply the level of the cost-driven degradation cascade in block 8 | AI Product Owner | P18 block 7 · document 52 §10.3 |

| Situation | Symptom or alert | First action | Escalate to | Reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Change in what users ask (usage drift)** | Alert on queries outside the validated scope or on a change of topics | Expand the evaluation set with the new cases and evaluate; if the use falls outside the purpose, restrict the scope | AI Product Owner | P25 · document 52 §4.2.6 |
| **Suspected prompt injection or anomalous agent action** | Repeated blocks or action outside purpose | Assess kill switch; preserve logs | Information security | P18 · P26 |
| **Complaint from an affected person** | Complaint received | Record; activate human review | AI Product Owner | P17 block 8 |
| **Possible discriminatory output** | Fairness alert, unequal responses in counterfactual pairs or complaint | Treat as an incident and classify severity | AI Risk Owner | P26 |

08

# Continuity and degraded mode

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **Degraded mode available** | | Description and how it is activated (P19). |
| **Process without AI** | | Who performs it and with what capacity. |
| **Maximum acceptable time without service** | | Consistent with P19. |
| **Recovery after degraded mode** | | Checks before returning to normal operation and who authorises it. |
| **Cost-driven degradation cascade** | | Only systems with variable consumption. Applicable levels (N1 optimisation, N2 fallback model, N3 reduced scope, N4 without AI), the trigger for each (for example, N1 at 80% and N2 at 100% of the budget), who activates them and uses excluded from N2 (document 52 §10.3). |
| **Fallback model** | | Identifier in P16, result of its evaluation before G5 and minimum quality required in P25. |

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# Access, records and retention

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **Management of user onboarding and offboarding** | | Procedure and owner. |
| **Periodic access review** | | Frequency and evidence. |
| **Records retained** | | Inference logs, agent actions, human validations, changes, alerts. |
| **Retention period** | | No shorter than that required by applicable regulation (document 34). |
| **Monitoring required by regulation (Enterprise)** | | What is monitored after go-live, who does it and how the provider or the authority is informed where appropriate (document 34). |

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# Continuity review (R6)

| Field | Content | Guidance |
|---|---|---|
| **Frequency** | | At least quarterly at Enterprise and half-yearly at Lite (01 §6.8). |
| **Next date** | | |
| **Information prepared** | | Realised value against hypothesis (P28), stability (P25), incidents and changes (P27), compliance and currency of the risk classification and intensity (P04, P11, P12). |
| **Criterion for proposing to bring G7 forward** | | Relevant deviations in value, risk or compliance. |

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# Quality criteria

Formal G5 and R6 criteria in document 21.

| # | Check | Status (Met · Not met · Not applicable · Pending) |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | All operational roles have a holder and a deputy. | |
| 2 | Routines have a frequency, an owner and a record. | |
| 3 | The types of change and their approval are defined and connected with P27. | |
| 4 | Common situations have a first action and escalation. | |
| 5 | Degraded mode and the process without AI are described and are consistent with P19. | |
| 6 | The date of the next R6 is set according to intensity. | |
| 7 | For systems with variable consumption, the cost-driven degradation cascade is defined, does not deactivate critical controls and has been tested. | |

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# Approval and verification

| Function | Role | Name | Date | Signature or reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Author** | AI Operations Owner | | | |
| **Co-author** | AI Technical Owner | | | |
| **Verifier** | AI Office (Lite) · AI Auditor (Enterprise) | | | |
| **Approval** | Sponsor (Lite) · AI Committee (Enterprise), within the G5 decision | | | |

Segregation of duties: the operations owner does not verify evidence of their own operation (01 §8.1).

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# Version control

| Version | Date | Changes |
|---|---|---|
| **0.1** | 16-09-2026 | First version of the template. |
| **0.1** | 18-09-2026 | Cost-driven degradation cascade and fallback model in block 8; usage drift and counterfactual pairs in the common situations; quality criterion 7. |